

THE BECOMING INSTITUTE

OFFICIAL COURSE WORKBOOK

TEAMWORK & COLLABORATION

COURSE WORKBOOK

TEAM EXCELLENCE

8 Ways to Excel as a Team Person

Alone you go fast. Together you go far and arrive transformed.

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INTRODUCTION

Amy Edmondson of Harvard Business School, featured in this course, demonstrated that teams with psychological safety — where members feel safe to take risks, speak up, and be vulnerable — consistently outperform teams that lack it, even when the latter has more talented individuals.

Team excellence is not about being likeable. It is about being trustworthy, dependable, and intentionally collaborative. This workbook gives you the 8 frameworks, reflection tools, and practice exercises to become the team person every organisation wants and every team needs.

THE 8 WAYS — FRAMEWORK OVERVIEW

1. Know Your Role and Own It Completely

Exceptional team members do not need to be told twice. They claim their role with total responsibility.

2. Build Trust Before You Need It

Trust is a resource. Invest in it during calm seasons so it is available during turbulent ones.

3. Communicate Proactively

Never let a team member be surprised by your progress, problems, or decisions. Share before asked.

4. Master Constructive Conflict

Healthy teams argue about ideas. Unhealthy teams avoid all conflict. Learn the difference.

5. Give and Receive Feedback Generously

Feedback is the breakfast of champions. Create a culture where improvement is celebrated.

6. Amplify Others' Strengths

The best team members make others look brilliant. Ego costs the team; amplification wins.

7. Lead from Any Position

Leadership is not a title. It is the act of taking responsibility for outcomes beyond your role.

8. Build Team Culture Intentionally

Culture is not what you post on the wall. It is what you tolerate and what you celebrate.

PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY — THE FOUNDATION OF TEAM EXCELLENCE

Amy Edmondson's research identified psychological safety as the single strongest predictor of team performance. Google's Project Aristotle (2016) confirmed it: the best predictor of team success was not who was on the team, but whether members felt safe.

Psychological safety means: members believe they will not be punished for speaking up, admitting mistakes, asking questions, or proposing ideas. It is NOT comfort or conflict avoidance — it is productive vulnerability.

- Ask your team: "What is one thing I do that makes it harder for you to speak up?"
- When someone raises a concern, respond with curiosity, not defensiveness.
- Model vulnerability first: admit a mistake, share an uncertainty, ask for help.

REFLECTION & APPLICATION

On a scale of 1-10, how psychologically safe does your current team feel? What would move it up by 2 points?

What is one thing you can do this week to increase psychological safety for your team?

THE TRUST EQUATION IN TEAMS

Charles Green's Trust Equation: $\text{Trust} = (\text{Credibility} + \text{Reliability} + \text{Intimacy}) \div \text{Self-Orientation}$. The most dangerous element is self-orientation — when team members perceive that you are primarily serving your own interests, trust collapses rapidly regardless of your competence.

- Credibility: Do your words match your knowledge and experience?
- Reliability: Do you consistently do what you commit to?
- Intimacy: Do teammates feel safe sharing real challenges with you?
- Self-Orientation: Are you seen as serving the team or yourself first?

REFLECTION & APPLICATION

Which element of the trust equation is your current weakness? What will you do about it?

Name one teammate whose trust you need to rebuild. What is your first step?

CONSTRUCTIVE CONFLICT AND LENCIONI'S FIVE DYSFUNCTIONS

Patrick Lencioni's research identifies 5 dysfunctions that cripple teams — each one building on the last:

1. Absence of Trust (fear of vulnerability)
2. Fear of Conflict (artificial harmony)
3. Lack of Commitment (ambiguity and fence-sitting)
4. Avoidance of Accountability (low standards)
5. Inattention to Results (status and ego over outcomes)

The antidote starts at the base: build trust, and productive conflict becomes safe. Safe conflict leads to real commitment. Real commitment enables accountability. Accountability produces results.

REFLECTION & APPLICATION

Which of Lencioni's 5 dysfunctions is most present in a team you belong to? What is one step toward its antidote?

Describe a time when avoiding conflict cost your team more than the conflict itself would have.

GIVING FEEDBACK THAT ACTUALLY CHANGES BEHAVIOUR

The SBI Feedback Model (Situation, Behaviour, Impact) is the gold standard for constructive feedback:

S — Situation: Describe the specific context objectively.

B — Behaviour: Describe what you observed (not interpreted).

I — Impact: Describe the actual effect on the team, project, or relationship.

Example: "In yesterday's client presentation (S), when you interrupted the client three times (B), it created an impression of impatience and reduced their confidence in us (I)."

This model removes judgment, increases specificity, and makes feedback actionable.

- Give feedback within 24 hours of the event. Delayed feedback loses impact.
- Ask permission: "Would it be helpful if I shared an observation?"
- Separate the person from the behaviour: "That approach" not "You always..."
- Close with a question: "What do you think? Does this land for you?"

REFLECTION & APPLICATION

Write an SBI feedback message you need to deliver to someone this week:

What feedback do you need to ASK for from your team or leader? How will you ask?

30-DAY TRANSFORMATION PRACTICE PLAN

Week 1 — Foundation (Trust & Safety)

- Day 1-3: Identify your trust score on the Trust Equation. Work on your lowest dimension.
- Day 4-5: Have one "safety check" conversation with a teammate.
- Day 6-7: List 3 commitments you will keep this week without being reminded.

Week 2 — Communication & Conflict

- Day 8-10: Practice proactive updates — communicate progress before being asked.
- Day 11-12: In one meeting, raise a concern you would normally suppress.
- Day 13-14: Deliver one piece of SBI feedback to a teammate.

Week 3 — Amplification & Leadership

- Day 15-17: Deliberately amplify a teammate's contribution in a public setting.
- Day 18-19: Take ownership of one outcome beyond your official role.
- Day 20-21: Map the strengths of every person on your team.

Week 4 — Culture Building

- Day 22-25: Identify one cultural habit your team has that is costing performance. Name it.
- Day 26-28: Propose one cultural improvement. Take responsibility for implementing it.
- Day 29-30: Write your Team Excellence Declaration — your personal commitment.

MY TRANSFORMATION COMMITMENT

My single most important goal from this course:

Three specific actions I will take in the next 7 days:

How I will measure my progress:

Signature: _____ Date: _____

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Transforming Individuals. Building Leaders. Shaping Generations.

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This workbook accompanies the "8 Ways to Excel as a Team Person" course on the Origin platform.

This workbook is your practical companion for transformational learning. Every framework, worksheet, and reflection exercise has been designed to move you from insight to action — from knowing to becoming.

The Becoming Institute believes that education is not a destination — it is a daily practice. Carry this workbook with you. Return to it. Complete the exercises. Discuss them with your accountability partner. Teach them to someone else.

This is not just a guide. This is your blueprint.

Continue your journey at www.origin.com.ng

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